but also by economic growth, population and poor water management.

Moderator: As mentioned by Mr.Ramesh, water management seems to be the crucial point when we talk about water crisis. I now request Mr. Joseph to make a few suggestions.

Mr.Joseph : Well, to tackle water crisis, a good water management strategy has to be adopted at all levels of planning, developing and distributing water for maximum usage. Say for example, in the field of agriculture, water intensive crops like rice and cotton should be grown in water rich regions and crops which need less water grown in other regions where there is less supply of water.

Moderator: Yes, Mr. Ramesh, what have you got to say about this?

Mr.Ramesh: To minimize water crisis, the main option is to share water, not only in the trans-boundary river basins but also in the river basins within nations and states.

Mr.Joseph: I would like to put forth the causes for this water scarcity. Shortfall of rain is the most important issue, that stems from deforestation. The absence of bunds and encroachments at the catchment areas also aggravate the water shortage issue.

Mr.Ramesh: But the good news is that there are always solutions to our problems. Our motto should be "The less water used, the more water saved." This will go a long way, towards addressing the current crisis. But for the solutions to be effective they need to be implemented vigilantly.

Moderator : Having discussed the status, causes and problems, let us also consider some practical solutions such as

- ❖ do not keep taps running
- ❖ only use what is needed resourcefully
- ❖ practise sustainable home living
- ❖ recycle used water
- ❖ create awareness of the dire consequences of water resource abuse
- ❖ get more involvement from people

By now we are aware how critical our global water shortage is.

Now the panellists are open for questions from the audience.

Unit 6

Text for listening

Hi everyone! Welcome to our guided tour to a wonderful hiking trail, high up a forested hillside to the Mystery Spot. Gravity and other forces go haywire at this pseudo – scientific anomaly, discovered in 1940. The site is located in Santa Cruz, California amongst the Oak and Eucalyptus trees, near Granite Creek, and within the California Redwood forest. It is a circular area of effect around 150 feet or 46 metres in diameter. Within the Mystery Spot you will be stunned as your perceptions of the laws of physics and gravity are questioned. On this gravity hill you will experience, tilt-induced visual illusion. The illusion experienced by visitors results from the oddly tilted environment as well as standing on a tilted floor. These visual illusions include balls

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